CHAROTAR UNIVERSITY OF SCIENCE AND TECHNOLOGY (CHARUSAT)
FACULTY OF TECHNOLOGY & ENGINEERING • DEPARTMENT OF COMPUTER ENGINEERING

TECHNICAL ASSESSMENT REPORT
HDLC PROTOCOL BIT STUFFING & FRAMING SYSTEM

Design, Algorithmic Implementation, Empirical Benchmarking & Academic Verification

Course Code & Name: ITUC201 — Fundamentals of Computer Networks	**Candidate Name: Bhavy Gol**
Assigned Lab Assignment: Bit Stuffing & Destuffing in HDLC Protocol	**Student Enrollment ID: 25CS016**
Academic Term: B.Tech Computer Engineering (Sem 3 / 2026-27)	**Submission Date:** October 2026

1. Abstract

This technical report documents the complete academic engineering, theoretical analysis, software implementation, and empirical validation of sender bit stuffing and receiver destuffing protocols based on High-Level Data Link Control (HDLC) standards (ISO/IEC 13239). Developed under **Student ID: 25CS016 (Candidate: Bhavy Gol)** for course **ITUC201 (Fundamentals of Computer Networks)** at CHARUSAT, the system delivers an end-to-end framework featuring a production-grade Python 3 core algorithm library, an interactive desktop GUI visualizer, a headless command-line demonstration interface, an automated benchmark evaluation suite, and a fully solved 7-mark university examination reference package. Empirical tests across diverse bit sequences demonstrate 100% roundtrip data integrity and deterministic boundary protection with zero transmission anomalies.

2. Objectives

- **Data Transparency Guarantee:** Design and execute a sender-side bit stuffing mechanism that unconditionally prevents the emergence of the 8-bit HDLC flag delimiter (`01111110`) within arbitrary payload bodies.
- **Lossless Stream Recovery:** Implement receiver-side destuffing logic that strips artificially injected zeros, restores original binary data with 100% precision, and flags transmission corruptions.
- **Algorithmic & Mathematical Modeling:** Analyze algorithmic time and space complexities, deriving formal overhead equations as a function of payload length and 1-bit cluster distribution.
- **Interactive Educational Visualizer:** Build a responsive graphical user interface (GUI) providing step-by-step bit tracking, real-time pipeline status, and immediate verification audit trails.
- **Rigorous University Examination Alignment:** Provide formal solutions to 7-mark and multi-mark university examination questions according to CHARUSAT evaluation benchmarks.

3. Theory of HDLC Protocol & Bit Stuffing

High-Level Data Link Control (HDLC) is a standardized bit-oriented protocol operating at Layer 2 (Data Link Layer) of the OSI reference model. Unlike byte-oriented protocols that rely on character escaping (e.g., PPP byte stuffing), HDLC operates continuously on raw bit streams regardless of word boundaries. HDLC frames are enclosed between unique synchronization patterns known as **Flag Delimiters**, defined as the octet `01111110` **(0x7E)**.

The Transparency Dilemma: Because user payload data can contain arbitrary binary sequences, user files or encrypted packets frequently contain the bit pattern `01111110` by coincidence. In the absence of preventive mechanisms, receiver hardware clock circuitry interprets this embedded bit sequence as a closing delimiter, prematurely truncating the frame, corrupting transmission, and dropping the remaining payload.

The HDLC Bit Stuffing Invariant: To prevent false frame synchronization, the sender inspects the payload sequentially. Whenever **five consecutive 1-bits** (`11111`) are transmitted, the sender unconditionally injects a single **'0' bit** into the stream. Consequently, a sequence of six consecutive 1-bits can *never* appear within the stuffed data region. At the receiver, upon detecting five consecutive 1s in the data stream, the following bit is examined: if '0', it is identified as an artificial stuff bit and stripped; if '1', it indicates a genuine frame delimiter (`01111110`) or an abort pattern (`01111111`).

4. Software Architecture & Implementation Methodology

The project follows a modular, decoupled software engineering architecture developed in Python 3. The architecture separates core mathematical protocol primitives from visual presentation, testing, and benchmark instrumentation.

Module Path	Primary Architectural Function	Candidate Attribution
`src/hdlc_core.py`	Functional protocol core containing `sender_bit_stuff()`, `receiver_bit_destuff()`, frame encapsulation, and step tracer.	**Bhavy Gol (25CS016)**
`src/hdlc_gui.py`	Interactive desktop GUI application with real-time stream visualizer, treeview bit audit, and test pattern loaders.	**Bhavy Gol (25CS016)**
`src/hdlc_cli.py`	Command-line console interface for headless execution, automated script piping, and batch debugging.	**Bhavy Gol (25CS016)**
`src/experiment_runner.py`	Automated benchmarking harness evaluating 25 test configurations across deterministic and synthetic patterns.	**Bhavy Gol (25CS016)**
`tests/test_hdlc.py`	Automated test suite asserting boundary invariants, malformed frame exceptions, and 50 randomized fuzz streams.	**Bhavy Gol (25CS016)**

Sender & Receiver Core Implementations:

```
# --- SENDER BIT STUFFING (O(N) Complexity) ---
def sender_bit_stuff(payload: str) -> str:
    clean_payload = validate_binary_string(payload, 'Payload')
    stuffed, consecutive_ones = [], 0
    for bit in clean_payload:
        stuffed.append(bit)
        if bit == '1':
            consecutive_ones += 1
            if consecutive_ones == 5:
                stuffed.append('0')  # Inject zero after 5 consecutive 1s
                consecutive_ones = 0
        else:
            consecutive_ones = 0
    return ''.join(stuffed)

# --- RECEIVER DESTUFFING & INTEGRITY CHECK ---
def receiver_bit_destuff(stuffed_payload: str) -> str:
    clean_stuffed = validate_binary_string(stuffed_payload, 'Stuffed')
    destuffed, consecutive_ones, idx = [], 0, 0
    n = len(clean_stuffed)
    while idx < n:
        bit = clean_stuffed[idx]
        destuffed.append(bit)
        if bit == '1':
            consecutive_ones += 1
            if consecutive_ones == 5:
                if idx + 1 < n and clean_stuffed[idx + 1] == '0':
                    idx += 1  # Skip/strip inserted zero bit
                    consecutive_ones = 0
                else:
                    raise ValueError(f'Corrupted HDLC stream at bit {idx+1}!')
        else:
            consecutive_ones = 0
        idx += 1
    return ''.join(destuffed)
```

5. Empirical Observations & Test Benchmark Results

The algorithmic implementation was subjected to comprehensive evaluation across standard academic test patterns and continuous randomized streams. All tests validated complete roundtrip fidelity with zero bit corruptions.

Test Case Pattern	Input Payload	Stuffed Bitstream	Bits Added	Overhead %	Restoration Status
Alternating Bits	`10101010`	`10101010`	0	0.00%	**PASS (100%)**
Exactly Five 1s	`11111`	`111110`	1	20.00%	**PASS (100%)**
Six Consecutive 1s	`111111`	`1111101`	1	16.67%	**PASS (100%)**
Flag-Identical Data	`01111110`	`011111010`	1	12.50%	**PASS (100%)**
Multiple Stuff Runs	`11111011111`	`1111100111110`	2	18.18%	**PASS (100%)**
University Exam Stream	`011111101111101`	`01111101011111001`	2	13.33%	**PASS (100%)**

6. Quantitative Bit Overhead Mathematical Analysis

The transmission efficiency of bit-stuffed synchronous frames is characterized by the **Stuffing Overhead Ratio**. Let L_{orig} denote the length of the input data payload in bits, and let K denote the total number of stuffed zero bits injected by the sender. The overhead percentage is defined mathematically as:

$$\text{Overhead } (\%) = (K / L_{orig}) \times 100\% = [\ (L_{stuffed} - L_{orig}) / L_{orig}\ ] \times 100\%$$

Theoretical Boundary Limits:

- **Lower Bound (Best Case = 0.00%):** Occurs when the payload contains no sequence of five contiguous 1s (e.g., alternating clock signals `101010` or all zeros). No stuffed bits are added; overhead is exactly zero.
- **Upper Bound (Worst Case = 20.00%):** Occurs when the payload is a pathological continuous run of 1s (`11111111...`). The sender is forced to insert a '0' bit after every 5 bits, yielding an asymptotic maximum overhead of exactly 1/5 = **20.00%**.
- **Average-Case Behavior:** For random binary payloads where bits are independent and identically distributed (P(1) = 0.5), the probability of encountering five consecutive 1s is $(0.5)^5 = 1/32 = 0.03125$. Thus, average stuffing overhead in real-world payload transmissions is under **3.125%**.

7. Worked University Examination Question (CHARUSAT ITUC201 Standard)

University Examination Question (7 Marks):
A sender application at the Data Link Layer needs to transmit the binary payload `011111101111101` over an HDLC synchronous serial link.
1. Show the step-by-step sender bit-stuffing procedure and state the resulting stuffed payload.
2. Construct the complete HDLC-style framed bit stream transmitted over the physical medium.
3. Demonstrate receiver destuffing step-by-step and prove that the original payload is restored.
4. Calculate the bit stuffing overhead in bits and percentage.
5. Explain why bit stuffing is mandatory for HDLC frame transparency.

Step-by-Step Formal Solution:

Step 1: Original Payload: `011111101111101` (Original Length = 15 bits).

Step 2: Sender Bit Stuffing Passes:
- The sender scans bits 1 through 6: `0 1 1 1 1 1`. Having encountered five consecutive 1s, it unconditionally injects '0' at stuffed index 7 ➔ `011111`**`0`**`10...`
- The sender continues through bit 13: encountering another sequence of five consecutive 1s, it injects '0' at stuffed index 15 ➔ `...11111`**`0`**`01`
- **Resulting Stuffed Payload: `0111110101111101`** (Length = 17 bits; exactly 2 zeros injected).

Step 3: HDLC Frame Construction: Opening Flag + Stuffed Payload + Closing Flag = **`01111110`** `0111110101111101` **`01111110`** (Total physical transmission = 8 + 17 + 8 = **33 bits**).

Step 4: Receiver Destuffing: The receiver strips opening/closing flags, encounters five 1s at index 6, removes stuffed bit 7 ('0'), encounters five 1s at index 14, removes stuffed bit 15 ('0'), cleanly restoring payload: **`011111101111101`** (**PASS — 100% Lossless Match**).

Step 5: Overhead Calculation: Overhead = (2 / 15) × 100% = **13.33%**.

8. Engineering Scope, Limitations & Protocols

• **Framing Scope:** This educational engineering package models core framing flags (01111110) and bit stuffing. Production HDLC frames also encapsulate an 8-bit Address field, an 8-bit/16-bit Control field, and a 16-bit or 32-bit Frame Check Sequence (CRC-CCITT FCS).
• **Error Detection vs Transparency:** Bit stuffing guarantees data transparency; it does not protect against physical line inversion. In production stacks, bit stuffing is applied *after* CRC generation at sender and removed *before* CRC validation at receiver.

9. Conclusions

The NetVista 3D HDLC bit stuffing system successfully achieves all stated academic and engineering milestones. By enforcing deterministic five-one detection and unconditional zero injection, the protocol guarantees 100% data transparency over synchronous channels with strictly bounded overhead (0% to 20%). The system provides robust software engineering, automated test reproducibility, interactive visualization, and complete alignment with CHARUSAT university examination standards under **Candidate: Bhavy Gol (Student ID: 25CS016)**.

10. Academic References & Declaration

1. Tanenbaum, A. S., & Wetherall, D. J. (2011). *Computer Networks* (5th ed.). Pearson Prentice Hall.
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3. ISO/IEC 13239:2002. *Information technology — High-level data link control (HDLC) procedures*.
4. Stallings, W. (2014). *Data and Computer Communications* (10th ed.). Pearson.

Academic Integrity & AI Declaration:
This project represents authentic academic engineering authored by **Bhavy Gol (Student ID: 25CS016)** for course ITUC201 at CHARUSAT. Generative AI tools were used solely as an assistive aid for formatting, diagram code generation, and presentation layout. All core logic, derivations, tests, and viva solutions were independently verified and authored.